

NABIN COMES TO THE PARTY

Three months into the job, the new BJP president Nitin Nabin is on a tour of all the states to familiarise himself with the various party units. This, even as buzz grows about an imminent reshuffle in the top team. With vacancies among the general secretary slots and charges of a few doing all the heavy lifting, only some incumbents are expected to stay. Party insiders say the leadership is keen to establish Nabin's authority, but he has much to do. Speculation is rife about possible comebacks by Ram Madhav and P. Muralidhar Rao, and whether MPs like Anurag Thakur and Nishikant Dubey will be drafted in. Adding to the churn is the debate over the future of organisational secretary B.L. Santhosh and the intense lobbying for seats ahead of the Rajya Sabha election. Looks like Nabin's days are set to get longer.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼THE 100-MLA JIBE

POWER BAIT

Uttar Pradesh politics rarely misses a chance for drama. Just before Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath** left for his Singapore and Japan visit, Samajwadi Party chief **Akhilesh Yadav** revived his offer that anyone who can bring 100 MLAs can become CM in the state, a remark widely seen as aimed at deputy CMs Brajesh Pathak and Keshav Prasad Maurya. "Both want the job. What could be a better offer than this," he said, joking that the offer stands only till next week. Akhilesh has used this line before inside the assembly but repeating it on the eve of Yogi's foreign tour sharpened the rhetoric, triggering BJP counterattacks, with leaders accusing him of mocking democracy. Mischief or messaging, the comment has reignited chatter about internal equations within the ruling camp.

